BIG FEELINGS, SMALL STEPS

THE FEELINGS FORECAST

A weather reporter's guide to noticing and navigating emotions

SUN

CLOUDS

STORM

OBSERVE

Name your internal weather.

NOTICE

Look for weather clues.

RESPOND

Choose a helpful tool.

FACILITATOR-READY SAMPLE

20-minute small-group session | Grades 2-4

Includes facilitator script, student weather report, scenario cards, and exit ticket.

Facilitator guide

Learning objectives, preparation, and first 7 minutes

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Students will (1) identify an emotion using a personal weather metaphor, (2) notice at least one body or environmental clue, and (3) select a supportive response.

PREPARE

Print the student weather report (page 4) and scenario cards (page 5). Provide pencils. Invite children to pass, point, draw, or share aloud. Avoid assigning a fixed emotion to any weather symbol.

CORE MESSAGE

Feelings are information, not instructions. We cannot always choose our weather, but we can choose how to care for ourselves.

0:00-3:00 | TODAY'S FORECAST

Say: "Weather changes throughout the day. Feelings can change, too. If you were reporting your inside weather right now, what would you say?"

Invite students to circle, draw, or privately choose a symbol. Reinforce: "There is no wrong forecast. Sunny is not better than rainy."

3:00-7:00 | WEATHER CLUES

Say: "Weather reporters notice clues: clouds, wind, temperature. Our bodies sometimes give us clues about feelings."

Offer examples: tense hands, fast heartbeat, a wiggly feeling, warm cheeks, or a relaxed jaw. Ask: "What clue might tell you a storm is building?" Let students name or draw a clue. Do not require personal disclosure.

Facilitator guide

Mindfulness script, application, and closure

7:00-12:00 | THE WEATHER STATION

Say slowly: "We are weather reporters. Our job is to notice, not to make the weather disappear. Keep your eyes open or look at one comfortable spot. Notice one color you can see. Notice one sound. Notice where your feet touch the floor or your hands touch the chair. If it feels comfortable, take an easy breath. What is your weather doing right now? You can keep that answer to yourself."

Pause between prompts. Then say: "A reporter does not have to stop the rain to notice it is raining."

Debrief: "Did your forecast stay the same or change? Either answer is okay."

ACCESSIBILITY & SAFETY

Do not require eyes closed, deep breathing, touch, or body scans. Offer the option to observe an object in the room instead. Invite students to pass.

12:00-18:00 | PACK YOUR WEATHER KIT

Read one or two scenario cards. For each, ask: (1) What might the forecast be? (2) What clues might you notice? (3) What could go in your weather kit?

Possible tools: pause and notice, ask a trusted adult for help, take space, use kind words, stretch, or try again. Emphasize that different children may choose different helpful tools.

18:00-20:00 | TOMORROW'S FORECAST

Students complete the exit ticket: "When I notice ___ weather, I can ___." Ask for a tool that is safe and realistic. Collect tickets or invite private sharing.

FACILITATOR CHECK

Look for a feeling/weather label and a relevant response. If a student cannot name a body clue, allow an observable situation clue instead.

My weather report

Name your weather. Notice your clues. Choose your next step.

SUNNY	CLOUDY	RAINY	STORMY
My meaning: _____	My meaning: _____	My meaning: _____	My meaning: _____

1 OBSERVE | My weather today is...

2 NOTICE | My weather clues are...

3 RESPOND | I can pack this in my weather kit...

MY EXIT TICKET

When I notice _____ weather, I can _____.

Weather-report scenario cards

Cut apart, discuss, or project for the group

FORECAST A

A classmate does not choose you as a partner.

What weather might show up? What could help?

FORECAST B

You studied hard, but the quiz feels difficult.

What clues might you notice? What is one next step?

FORECAST C

Your friend surprises you with exciting news.

Can big feelings be pleasant? How might your body react?

FORECAST D

You make a mistake during a group activity.

What might your weather kit include?

Remember: More than one forecast or response may fit. Ask what is safe, kind, and helpful.